



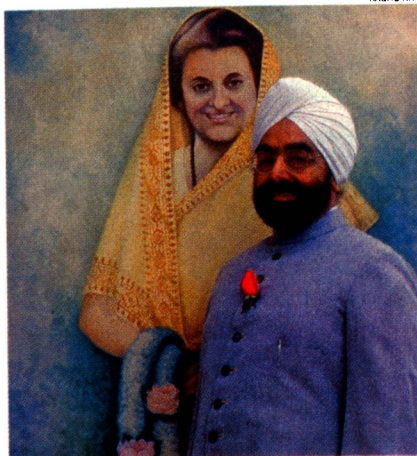
IN TRUE SPIRIT

"No man's life can be encompassed in one telling... What can be done is to try to be faithful in spirit and find one's way to the heart of the man." So went the dedication in Richard Attenborough's *Gandhi*. The film, starring Ben Kingsley as Gandhi, came very close to achieving that. The funeral sequence was filmed on January 31, 1981, 33 years to the day after Gandhi's real funeral. Over 300,000 extras were used in the scene, the most for any film, according to the *Guinness Book of World Records*.

"I WILL EVEN SWEEP THE FLOOR IF INDIRAJI ASKS ME TO."

Zail Singh

Sardar Zail Singh Ramgarhia, President of India from 1982-87, was criticised for his subservient attitude to Prime Minister Indira Gandhi. But his relations with Rajiv Gandhi were rocky from the start and deteriorated to such an extent that when *INDIA TODAY* broke its story about their cold war in February 1987, a Union minister hadn't called on Singh in two years, not even when summoned. But when in March 1987, after what was the longest President-Prime Minister meeting, lasting 130 minutes, the two emerged clasp-ing hands, it was evident that things had somewhat changed. When his term ended, he chose not to seek re-election.



ELSEWHERE...

- The Falklands War came to an end with the surrender of the Argentine garrison. Several thousand troops from Argentina had occupied the island the year before, laying claim to it.
- Italy won its first football World Cup in 44 years.
- The massacre of some 1,500 Palestinians by Lebanese Christian militarymen began in



West Beirut's Sabra and Chatilla refugee camps. The massacre triggered peace rallies in Israel with over 4,00,000 demonstrating in Tel Aviv.

6.1 lakh

the number of immigrant Indians in the Middle East. The UAE accounted for the most, with 3.5 lakh immigrants while Saudi Arabia and Kuwait had 1.5 lakh and 1.1 lakh, respectively.